

Hospital Discharge Planning

Learner guide | SWP-016 | School of Medical & Health Social Work

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Hospital Discharge Planning. By the end of the course, you should be able to coordinate safe, person-centred transitions from hospital to home or community care.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Coordinate safe, person-centred transitions from hospital to home or community care.
- Apply the key ideas from Discharge-risk assessment.
- Apply the key ideas from Transition coordination.
- Apply the key ideas from Follow-up and readmission prevention.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Discharge-risk assessment	medical, psychosocial, functional, financial, caregiver, and housing factors	10 to 15 minutes
2. Transition coordination	patient/family participation, interdisciplinary roles, medication and appointment continuity	10 to 15 minutes
3. Follow-up and readmission prevention	warning signs, referrals, documentation, and handover	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Discharge-risk assessment

This module focuses on medical, psychosocial, functional, financial, caregiver, and housing factors. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Medical
- Psychosocial
- Functional
- Financial
- Caregiver
- Housing factors

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of discharge-risk assessment in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of medical, psychosocial, functional, financial, caregiver, and housing factors. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through discharge-risk assessment safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Transition coordination

This module focuses on patient/family participation, interdisciplinary roles, medication and appointment continuity. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Patient/family participation
- Interdisciplinary roles
- Medication
- Appointment continuity

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of transition coordination in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of patient/family participation, interdisciplinary roles, medication and appointment continuity. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through transition coordination safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Follow-up and readmission prevention

This module focuses on warning signs, referrals, documentation, and handover. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Warning signs
- Referrals
- Documentation
- Handover

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of follow-up and readmission prevention in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of warning signs, referrals, documentation, and handover. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through follow-up and readmission prevention safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: risk factors.
- Review the distinction between: coordination.
- Review the distinction between: patient participation.
- Review the distinction between: follow-up.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.